

Lab 1B — Incident Response Runbook

Graded On-Call Recovery Procedure

Rule Zero

You are responding to an incident. You are NOT allowed to redeploy EC2 or RDS, rotate secrets blindly, or guess. You must observe, diagnose, and recover using existing tools.

Runbook Step 1 — Acknowledge

- Confirm CloudWatch alarm state is ALARM
- Record alert receipt time

Runbook Step 2 — Observe

- Check CloudWatch Logs (/aws/ec2/lab-rds-app)
- Filter for ERROR messages
- Document observed symptoms

Runbook Step 3 — Classify Failure

- Credential failure
- Network/security group failure
- Database availability failure
- Classification is graded

Runbook Step 4 — Validate Configuration Sources

- Retrieve Parameter Store values
- Retrieve Secrets Manager values
- Compare against known-good state

Runbook Step 5 — Containment

- Do not restart EC2
- Do not rotate secrets again
- Explicitly state system state preserved

Runbook Step 6 — Recovery

- Credential drift: reconcile secret vs DB password
- Network block: restore SG rule on 3306
- DB stopped: start DB and wait for Available

Runbook Step 7 — Validation

- Confirm alarm returns to OK
- Confirm logs normalize
- Confirm /list endpoint works